

The four postures, and the structure each requires

You lead the category

DEFENCE

You are the leader

Concentration:
the top few hold the share

Attack yourself before
a challenger does

OFFENCE

You are the challenger

A leader with a
weakness in its strength

Attack that weakness
on a narrow front

You do not

FLANK

You create the category

Fragmentation:
no one owns the category

Move into uncontested
ground and defend it

GUERRILLA

You are the small player

A corner the big
players cannot serve

Own a niche small
enough to hold

Category has an owner

Category is contested

Postures after Ries and Trout, Marketing Warfare (1986); structural conditions mapped to Singapore industry data in Small Island, Crowded Market. Author analysis.